Case Study for DIFA Velachery, Chennai

Final report for the BDM capstone Project

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1 Executive Summary and Title

Turning sales data and campus micro-influence into growth for DIFA Velachery

DIFA Velachery is a franchise-owned, franchise-operated fashion-accessories store in Chennai. The owner brought me two worries: she could not see which parts of her range were carrying the store, and she was paying about ₹40,000 a month for marketing without feeling better known locally.

For the first problem I went back to the sales file the owner shared with me. After I dropped the December part-week, put the nail-polish item codes into one category and set the packaging aside, the eight full months from April to November 2025 leave ₹1,05,39,048 across 38 categories. Seven of those categories produce 81.8% of it, and earrings alone produce 51.0%. Five earring sub-types carry roughly 72% of earring revenue and about 37% of the whole store. Average monthly revenue in August to November sits 3.2% below April to July while units fall 6.6% — fewer pieces leaving the store at a higher average price. Bangles, watches and pouches fell hardest between the two halves; bracelets, neck sets and chain-pendant sets rose.

For the second problem I collected fifteen NIFT Chennai student accounts by hand from public Instagram profiles, and I rebuilt the score I used earlier, because it multiplied two numbers on very different scales and one account decided the ranking. My corrected score gives 0.60 weight to a scaled view score and 0.40 to a scaled posting-efficiency score. I shortlist six students for a thirty-day paid pilot, each with a unique code, so that store visits and sales can be counted instead of assumed.

Table 1: Headline figures for the analysis window (April–November 2025)

Measure	Value	Measure	Value
Customer-merchandise revenue	₹1,05,39,048	Merchandise categories after correction	38
Net units sold	81,520	Categories reaching 80% of revenue	7
Active product identifiers (U-IDs)	5,813	Earring share of revenue	51.0%
Average realised price per unit	₹129.28	Aug–Nov vs Apr–Jul average revenue	−3.2%

Source: owner-shared extract Business sales data.xlsx, sheet "Clean data"; author's calculation. Revenue is Item Net Amount and units are Sold Qty, both already net of returns.

2 Detailed Explanation of Analysis Process/Method

2.1 The business, its model and the two problem statements

I described the business in my mid-term report, so I will keep this short and only repeat what the rest of this report depends on. DIFA Velachery sells affordable fashion accessories — earrings, neck sets, hair accessories, bangles, cosmetics, small bags and similar items — from one shop in a Chennai neighbourhood that has offices, colleges and homes around it. It runs on a franchise-owned, franchise-operated basis, so the owner pays the rent, staff and marketing while the brand and most of the stock come from the franchisor. Everything is sold inside the shop; there is no website and no delivery. I keep coming back to this one fact, because it means every rupee in my data started with somebody walking through the door.

I made the business model canvas in Figure 1 together with the owner during the mid-term stage, and I am showing it again because every recommendation I make in Section 4 connects to one of its blocks. Two blocks matter most to me. The revenue-streams block has only one entry, in-store purchase, so footfall is the only thing that moves revenue. The cost-structure block has a fixed marketing cost of about ₹40,000 a month, and the owner cannot link that money to anything she can count.

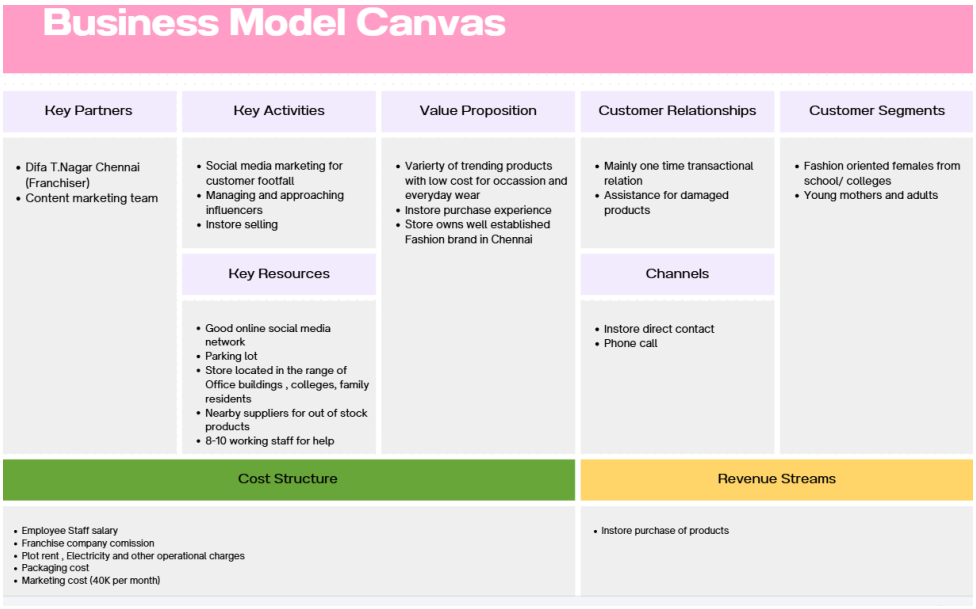


Figure 1: Business model canvas of DIFA Velachery

The SWOT in Figure 2 is the owner's own view of the store, and I have not changed it, so that my results in Section 3 can be read against it. The weakness I am working on directly is the last one in the list: limited data-driven understanding of category performance and price-based demand. The opportunity I am working on is the growing interest in fashion jewellery among Gen Z customers, which is why I think a pool of design-college students is worth testing.

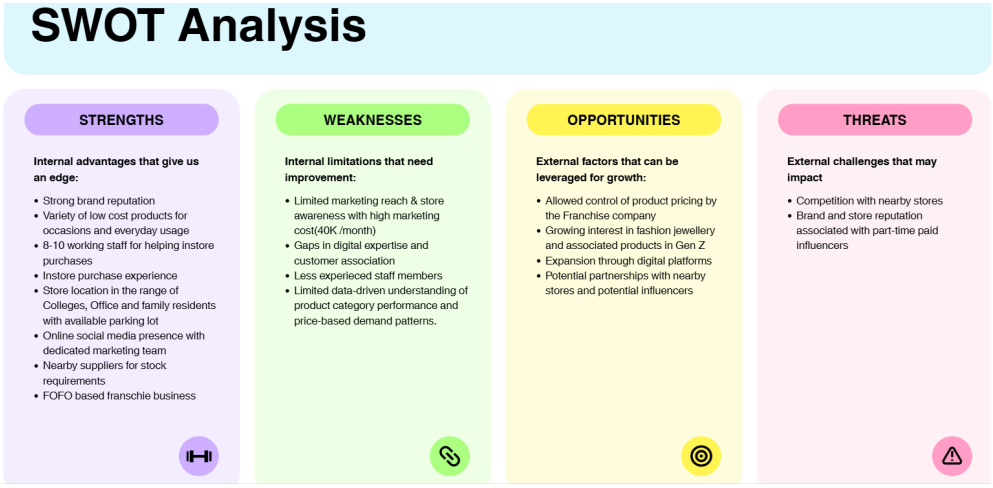


Figure 2: SWOT position of the store as described by the owner

These are the same two problem statements I fixed in my mid-term report, and this final report has to answer both of them. **P1 — product and store performance:** the owner has no measured view of which categories, price points and sub-types are carrying the store, so buying and display decisions are made on impression. **P2 — local brand awareness and marketing efficiency:** about ₹40,000 a month is being spent with no measured link to footfall, and the store still does not feel well known next to its competitors.

Some of what I write below comes from the data and some of it comes from what the owner told me, so I have labelled the claims to keep the two apart. **[Dataset]** means I calculated it myself from the sales file or from the student sheet, and anyone can recalculate it. **[Owner-reported]** means the owner told me this in conversation — useful, but I cannot check it against my data. **[To be tested]** means it is something I am suggesting or guessing, and nobody has measured it yet, so it should not be read as a result.

There is one kind of statement I have deliberately kept out of this report. My file has no cost price, no stock figures and no record of items going out of stock, so I cannot work out margin, and I cannot call a

slow-selling category weak, unprofitable or something to drop. A category that sells few pieces might be a high-margin one, or it might simply have been out of stock for six weeks and I would not be able to tell. Wherever a category sells little, I say it sells little and I stop there.

2.2 Continuity from the mid-term report

In my mid-term report I did the groundwork that this report sits on, so I am not repeating it here. There I explained how I got the file from the owner and how I cleaned it, why I had to build a composite U-ID because the raw "Item Name" field is really a category and not a product, why I could safely merge the five discount columns after checking every row with a logical test, and why I kept the return rows in the file instead of deleting them. I also gave a first look at the numbers: a gently falling revenue line, an average realised price of about ₹129, and a catalogue in which about 91% of the distinct products have an MRP at or below ₹500. I still stand by all of that and I treat it as settled.

At the end of the mid-term report I promised that in the final report I would build a category portfolio quadrant, a heat map, a view of the realised price customers actually pay, and a proper shortlist of local micro-influencers. Sections 3 and 4 are me keeping that promise. The reason I needed to go further is that the mid-term could only answer "is revenue falling?", while what the owner really wants to know is "what inside my shop is producing the revenue, and what should I do differently?" So in this report I have added four things to what I did before: a category correction that turns 89 raw labels into 38 categories a shopkeeper would recognise, a strict eight-month window so that no chart is spoiled by the one-week December, a view of the portfolio weighted by revenue instead of the mid-term's count of products, and a corrected scoring method for the influencer half in place of the raw scope column I had used earlier.

2.3 Working dataset, window and category-correction logic

I started from the same "Clean data" sheet I built in the mid-term stage. It has **17,898 valid item-month records** across **5,888 product identifiers** and **89 raw category labels**, which are the same three counts I reported in the mid-term. Each row is one product variant in one calendar month. The owner exported the file on 7 December 2025, so December 2025 has only the first week of trading in it — 593 records against a normal month of about 2,100. I flagged this in the mid-term and I have kept the same rule here: I leave December out of every trend, average, comparison and chart, so my working window is the eight full months from April to November 2025. **[Dataset]**

When I started building the category charts I found that the 89 raw labels are not 89 categories a shopkeeper would recognise, and I had to fix two things before any of my category charts could be honest. First, nail polish is sitting in the file as 37 separate item codes of the form CS-NP-nnn, and each of those is a shade, not a category. If I had left them alone they would have broken one real product line into 37 tiny pieces and made my category count look bigger than it is, so I combined all of them into one category called NAIL POLISH. Second, boxes, paper bags and size-coded pouches are packaging that the shop gives out with a sale, not something a customer walks in to buy. If I had left them in a category ranking I would have been putting a carry bag next to a neck set, so I took them out of all category-level work. I have written down exactly how much I removed in Table 2, so that anyone who disagrees with me can add it back. I kept NECK TRAY - SMALL in. It sold only once in eight months, but it is a real item somebody can buy, and dropping an awkward row is not the same thing as correcting a label.

Table 2: Category-correction audit: from 89 raw labels to 38 categories

Step	Action	Category count	Volume affected
0	Raw category labels on the clean sheet	89	—
1	Combine all CS-NP-* item codes into one category NAIL POLISH	89 → 53 (−37, +1)	₹65,274 retained
2	Exclude non-merchandise packaging: BOX *, PAPER BAG S*, POUCH S*, POUCH-S* (15 labels)	53 → 38	338 units / ₹9,732
3	Retain NECK TRAY - SMALL as saleable merchandise	38	1 unit / ₹250
✓	Customer-merchandise categories used in Section 3	38	₹1,05,39,048

Source: author's calculation. Excluded packaging is 338 units and ₹9,732 across April–November, which is under 0.1% of merchandise revenue. [Dataset]

2.4 Definitions and formulas used

Every number I report rests on two definitions, and they are the same ones I used in the mid-term. **Revenue** is the Item Net Amount field and **units** is Sold Qty. Both are already net of returns, because a return is written into the file as a negative quantity and a negative amount on the same product, so it takes itself off the total. In my eight-month window there are 17 such return rows, which remove 17 units and ₹5,023. I have not made any separate adjustment for returns anywhere in this report, because none is needed.

Table 3: Formulas used in this report

Quantity	Formula	Where used
Monthly revenue	Revenue(m) = Σ Item Net Amount over all rows in month m	Figure 3
Monthly units	Units(m) = Σ Sold Qty over all rows in month m	Figure 3
Linear trend	Ordinary least-squares fit of the eight observed monthly values against t = 0…7	Figure 3
Realised selling price	Realised price = Revenue ÷ Units, computed per category over the window	Figures 3, 4
Half-against-half change	Change % = (mean monthly revenue Aug–Nov ÷ mean monthly revenue Apr–Jul − 1) × 100	Figures 3, 7
Row-normalised monthly share	Share(c,m) = Units(c,m) ÷ Σ_m Units(c,m) × 100, so each category row sums to 100%	Figure 5
MRP band	Bands on MRP, left-exclusive and right-inclusive: (0,50], (50,100], (100,200], (200,500], (500,1K], (1K,1.5K], (1.5K,2K], (2K,∞)	Figure 6
Cumulative revenue share	Cum%(k) = $\Sigma_{i \le k}$ Revenue(i) ÷ total revenue × 100, categories sorted descending	Figure 8
ABC bands	A = categories up to and including the first to reach 80% cumulative; B = the next up to and including the first to reach 95%; C = the remainder	Figure 8
Coefficient of variation	CV = sample standard deviation of the eight monthly values ÷ their mean × 100	Section 3.1
Ability	Ability = followers ÷ number of posts	Section 2.6
Scaled scores	Score(x) = (x − min x) ÷ (max x − min x), applied separately to peak reel views and to Ability	Section 2.6
Scope score	Scope = (0.60 × view score + 0.40 × ability score) × 100	Figure 10

2.5 Why these methods and not the alternatives

I did the mid-term work in Excel, and I said there that Excel was the right tool for a descriptive pass because the owner could open every pivot and check it herself. I also said that if the final stage needed the same work re-run again and again, I would move to a script. That is what happened. In this stage I have to apply the same category correction to seven different charts, keep the eight-month window everywhere, and group the same data in several different ways. If I did that by hand I would very likely make the exact mistake this report is meant to avoid — one chart built on 89 labels while the next one is built on 38. So I moved the final analysis into a single Python notebook, using pandas to add up the numbers and matplotlib and seaborn to draw the figures. I wrote the correction rules once at the top and drew every chart from that same corrected table. I also put two checks in the notebook that stop it if any of the eight months is missing or if any revenue, quantity or MRP value is blank.

For each of my seven sales charts I had an alternative in mind, and I want to say why I picked what I picked. I used a **two-axis portfolio screen** (Figure 4) instead of a plain revenue ranking, because volume and realised price pull in opposite directions and one ranking would hide that. I used a **row-normalised heat map** (Figure 5) instead of twelve separate trend lines, because making each row add up to 100% takes the size difference between categories out of the picture and lets me compare their shapes. I compared the **average of the first four months against the average of the last four** (Figure 7) instead of fitting a slope to each category, because an average of four months is much less affected by

one odd month than a line drawn through eight points. And I used **ABC classification** (Figure 8) instead of just taking a top ten, because the 80/95 rule says exactly where I am cutting and anyone can re-run it at a different cut-off.

There are three families of method that I looked at and decided not to use, and I said much the same thing in the mid-term. Time-series forecasting and seasonal decomposition need far more than eight monthly points before they can estimate a seasonal effect, so if I ran ARIMA or SARIMA on this data the output would look impressive and mean almost nothing. Customer segmentation methods like RFM or clustering need customer or bill identifiers, and my file simply does not have any. Ranking categories by profit needs cost price, which I do not have either. With data of this length and shape I think the honest thing to do is careful, well-documented description, and that is what I have done in Section 3.

2.6 Method for the micro-influencer half

I collected fifteen candidate accounts by hand, using the sourcing method I described in the mid-term report. I made a separate Instagram account for this, started at the official NIFT Chennai pages, and then worked outwards through the likes, comments, tagged posts and mutual connections of the well-known public student profiles. For each account I noted down the follower count, the number of posts, the highest view count any of their reels had reached, the graduating year, the gender and the date of their most recent post. I took the snapshot in mid-January 2026. Fourteen of the fifteen are female, which matches both the store's customers and the part of the campus network I was moving through. I kept one male candidate on purpose, and I explain why in Section 3.8.

Before I use any number from this sheet, there are four things I want to put on record about it.

- **I picked these accounts on purpose; they are not a random sample.** I found them by following one network, so my list leans towards whoever is well connected inside that network. I cannot draw any statistical conclusion about NIFT students in general, or about Chennai creators in general, from fifteen accounts I chose myself.
- **I could not check where their followers are.** These students study in Chennai, but that is not the same as their followers being in Chennai, and Instagram does not show audience location publicly. The whole idea rests on the audience being local, and right now I have not been able to test that at all. **[To be tested]**
- **The peak reel views are a best case, not what I should expect.** The "most viewed count" field is the highest number any one of their reels ever reached. It tells me the account has made something go viral at least once. It does not tell me what a campaign would reach, what a normal post reaches, how much of that reach is local, or anything at all about sales.
- **I did not collect engagement rate.** I did not record likes and comments per post, so my score cannot tell an engaged audience apart from a quiet one. If I were doing this again, this is the first field I would add.

When I first worked on this sheet I made a "Scope" column that simply multiplied peak views by an ability figure, without scaling either of them. Looking at it again for this report, I realised that was wrong. Peak views in my sheet run from about 3,500 all the way to 7.1 million, so that multiplication is decided almost entirely by the biggest view count, and my ranking was really just a ranking by views with some extra decimals on it. So I threw that column away and worked the score out again, this time scaling both inputs to a 0–1 range first, so that I am choosing the weights myself instead of letting the units choose them for me. The formulas are in Table 3. The 0.60 / 0.40 split is my own judgement and I would rather say so plainly: I put more weight on proven ability to make something travel, because a shop paying for awareness is really paying for reach, and I keep Ability — followers divided by posts — as the second part because it separates a student who built an audience in forty posts from one who needed a hundred and eighty.

3 Results and Findings

Every sales figure in this section comes from the corrected table I summarised in Table 1: eight full months, 38 categories, ₹1,05,39,048 of revenue and 81,520 net units. Anyone can reproduce every number I quote by running my notebook on the same sheet. Before I go on, I should connect this to the mid-term: there I reported 82,934 units for the whole file, and my 81,520 here is the same figure after I take out the 1,076 units of the December part-week and the 338 packaging units. Nothing has gone missing between the two reports.

3.1 Observed movement in revenue and units

In the mid-term I showed these two lines separately and said that both were gently declining. Here I have redrawn them on the corrected merchandise data and put them on one chart, so the two can be compared directly. In Figure 3 the revenue line runs between ₹11.25 lakh and ₹14.88 lakh, and the line I fitted through it falls by about ₹26,216 a month, while the unit line falls by about 324 units a month. I would not read either slope as a forecast, because with only eight points one strong or weak month moves the fitted line quite a lot. **[Dataset]**

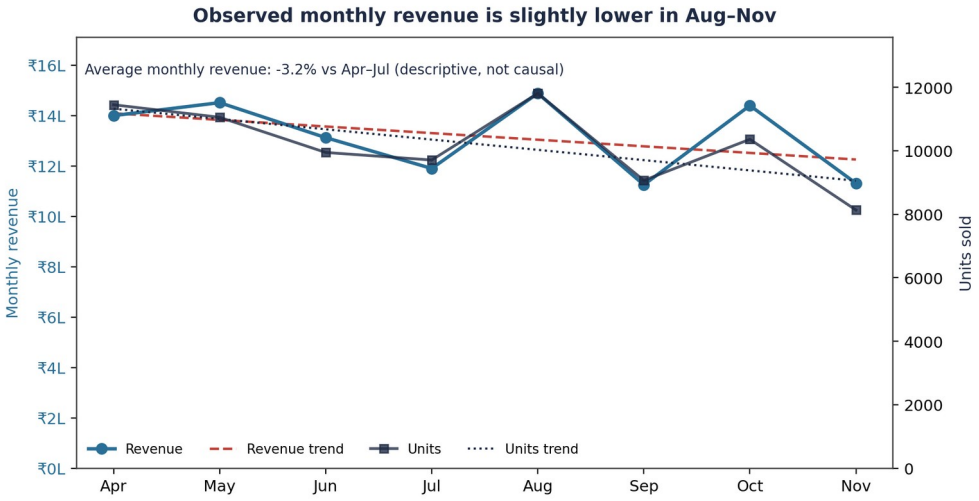


Figure 3: Observed monthly revenue (left axis) and units (right axis) for customer merchandise, April–November 2025, with linear trend lines

What I find more useful is the comparison printed on the chart, where I split the eight months into two halves. Average monthly revenue in August to November is **3.2% below** April to July — ₹12,96,227 against ₹13,38,535. Over the same split, average monthly units fall **6.6%**, from 10,538.5 to 9,841.5. For me the gap between those two numbers is the real finding. Revenue is holding up better than volume because the average realised price went up across the window, from ₹122.3 in April to ₹139.1 in November. Fewer pieces are leaving the shop, but each piece is worth about 14% more than it was in April. **[Dataset]**

The month-to-month movement is real but it is not wild. Revenue has a coefficient of variation of 11.4% and units 12.2%, which matches the roughly 11% I reported in the mid-term, so revenue is still the steadier of the two — again because the price is softening the drop in volume. August is the strongest revenue month at ₹14.88 lakh and September the weakest at ₹11.25 lakh, and November is the thinnest month for units at 8,133. These are the same two months I picked out in the mid-term; my figures are slightly smaller only because I have now taken the packaging lines out. The owner tells me the softer months are down to the north-east monsoon keeping people indoors and the quiet stretch right after Diwali. **[Owner-reported]** That sounds reasonable to me and it fits the shape of the curve, but I only have eight months with one monsoon and one Diwali in them, so I cannot separate a pattern that repeats every year from an ordinary ups-and-downs, and I am not going to claim that I can.

3.2 Portfolio screen: volume against realised price

This is the category quadrant I promised at the end of the mid-term report. In Figure 4 I have put all 38 categories on two axes the owner can actually do something about: how many pieces move, and what a piece really fetches at the till. The dividing lines are the medians across categories — 388 units and ₹144 realised price — and the size of each bubble is its revenue. I put the horizontal axis on a log scale only because the categories are so different in size that they would not otherwise fit on one chart. I want to be clear that this is a screening tool and not a ranking: without margin data it tells me where a category sits, not whether it is worth keeping. **[Dataset]**

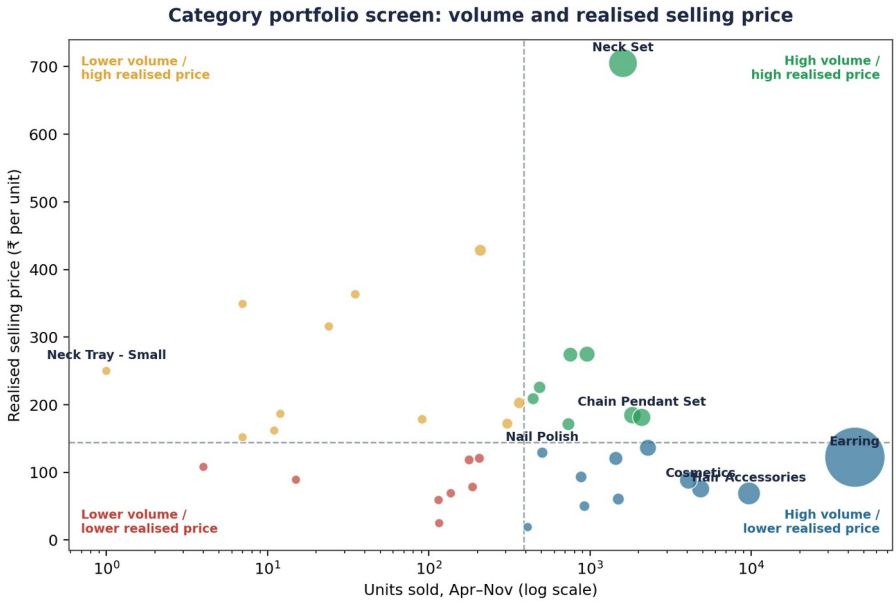


Figure 4: Category portfolio screen: units sold against realised selling price, bubble area proportional to revenue

The picture is very uneven, and the owner had never seen it put in numbers before. Eleven categories sit in the high-volume, lower-price corner and between them they carry ₹75.51 lakh, which is 71.6% of merchandise revenue — earrings dominate this group, with hair accessories, cosmetics and stationery alongside them. Eight categories sit in the high-volume, high-price corner and add ₹26.46 lakh, or 25.1%. Neck sets are the clearest example of this second group: they move only 1,602 pieces in eight months but each one fetches ₹705. The two lower-volume corners together hold 19 of the 38 categories and only 3.2% of revenue. **[Dataset]**

What I take from this is that the shop is really running two different engines side by side. One is a volume engine, where the profit on each piece is probably thin and everything depends on a lot of customers walking in. The other is a value engine made up of a few categories, where one sale is worth five to ten ordinary sales. I do not think the same action works for both, and I come back to that in Section 4.

3.3 How each category's sales spread across the months

This is the heat map I promised in the mid-term. I built it to answer something the store-level trend cannot tell me: does every category move together, or do some of them have their own rhythm? Each row in Figure 5 is one of the twelve largest categories, and I have made each row add up to 100% of that category's own eight-month units, so I can read a row across without the size of the category getting in the way. If a category were perfectly flat it would show 12.5% in every cell. **[Dataset]**

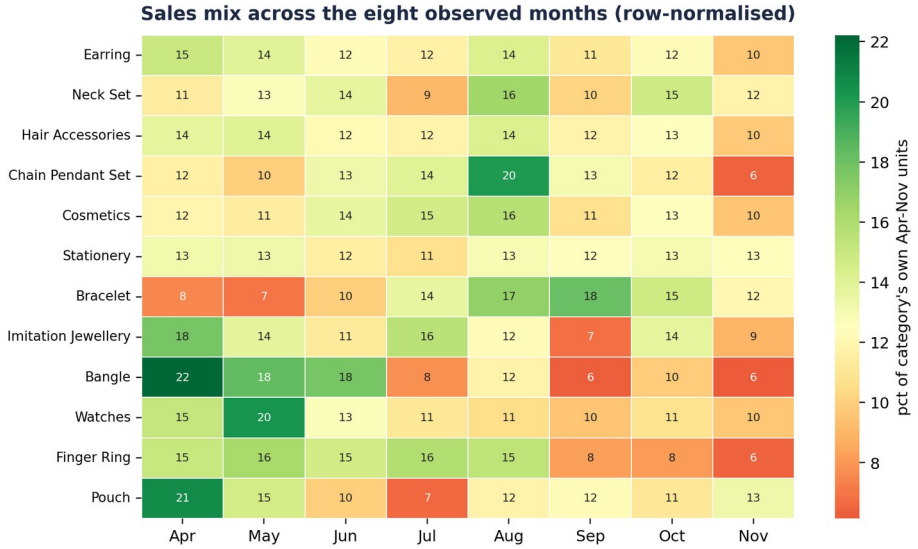


Figure 5: Row-normalised monthly sales mix of the twelve largest categories; each row sums to 100% of that category's own April–November units

Most of the rows sit close to flat, which fits what the owner told me and what I wrote in the mid-term — that the shop runs on steady everyday demand rather than on occasion buying. The interesting rows are the ones that do not sit flat. Bangles are bunched into the first half and thin out afterwards, and watches do the same. Bracelets and neck sets do the opposite, running lighter early and heavier late. Cosmetics and stationery both lift noticeably around the middle months. **[Dataset]**

It is tempting to give each of these shapes a season, and I am deliberately not doing that. I only have each calendar month once, so I cannot tell a seasonal pattern apart from a buying decision, a gap in supply or a change in what was on display. What the heat map does tell me is narrower but still useful: the store-level decline in Section 3.1 is not the whole range fading evenly. It is several categories moving in opposite directions and cancelling each other out, which tells me the response has to be category by category rather than one push across everything.

3.4 Where the money sits by price band

In the mid-term I showed with a Pareto chart that about 91% of the distinct products have an MRP at or below ₹500, and that the ₹200–500 and ₹100–200 bands together hold 66.7% of them. But that was a statement about the catalogue, not about the money. Here I ask the harder question — where the revenue actually comes from — by crossing the ten largest categories against the same MRP bands in Figure 6. The text in each cell is revenue and the shading is that cell's share of its own category's revenue. **[Dataset]**

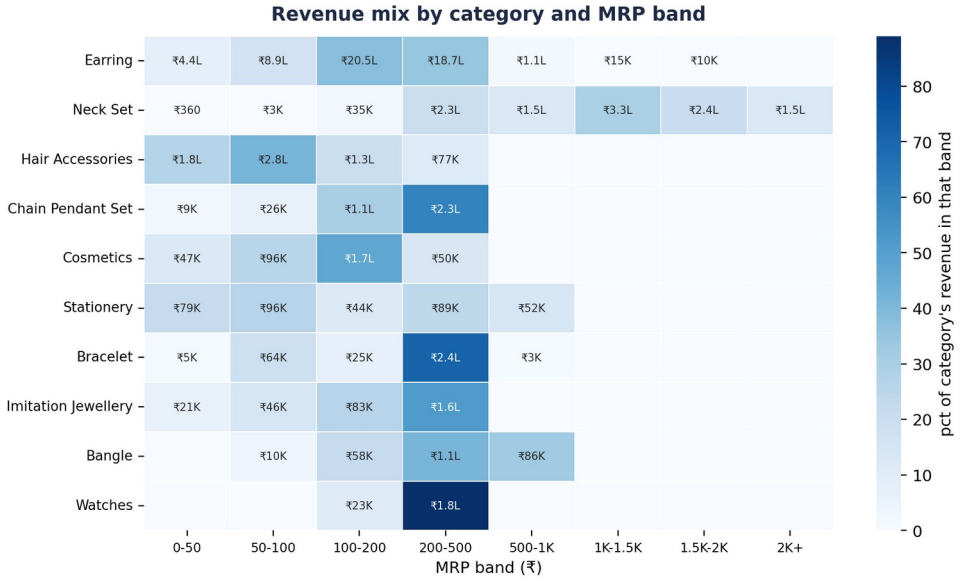


Figure 6: Revenue mix by category and MRP band for the ten largest categories; bands are left-exclusive and right-inclusive

Across the whole shop the ₹100–₹500 range brings in **64.7%** of merchandise revenue — 30.7% from the ₹100–₹200 band and 34.0% from ₹200–₹500. Everything at or below ₹500 accounts for 88.3%, and everything above ₹1,000 for only 7.2%. So my catalogue finding from the mid-term and my revenue finding here agree with each other, and I think that is worth saying out loud: this shop is not quietly living off a small number of expensive items. **[Dataset]**

The differences between the rows are where I think the buying decisions really sit. Earrings, hair accessories, cosmetics and stationery are bunched below ₹200. Neck sets are the opposite — almost all of their revenue is above ₹500 and a good part of it is above ₹1,000, which is exactly why their realised price came out at ₹705 in Figure 4. Bangles and watches spread across the middle bands. If the owner is deciding what to reorder, I think this is far more useful than one overall average price, because it tells her which shelf each category is actually trading on. **[Dataset]**

3.5 Which categories moved between the two halves

In Figure 7 I break the store-level 3.2% down into its parts. For each of the twelve largest categories I have compared the average monthly revenue in August to November against the average in April to July. **[Dataset]**

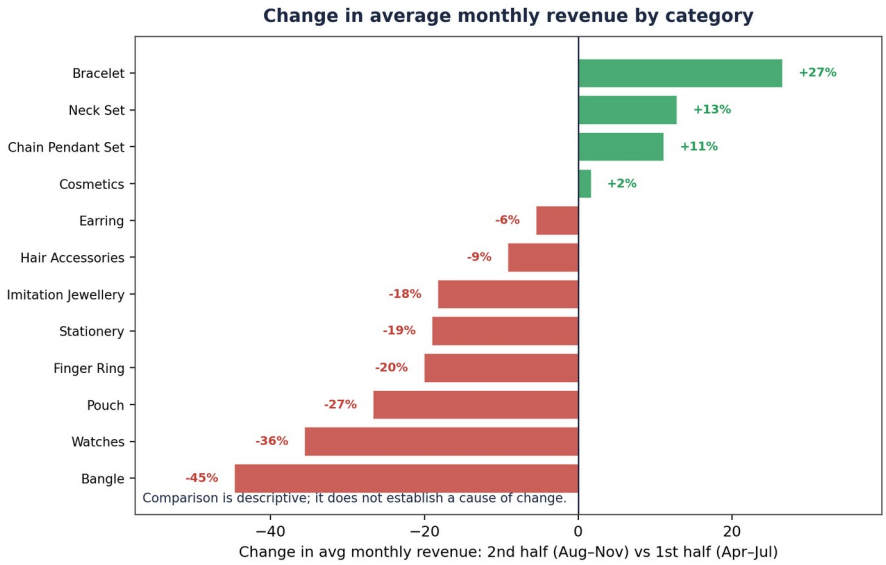


Figure 7: Change in average monthly category revenue, August–November against April–July, for the twelve largest categories

The single store-level number hides a very wide spread. Four categories fell by a fifth or more: bangles by 44.8%, watches by 35.7%, pouches by 26.7% and finger rings by 20.1%, with stationery and imitation jewellery close behind at around 19%. Four categories rose: bracelets by 26.6%, neck sets by 12.9%, chain-pendant sets by 11.2% and cosmetics only just, at 1.7%. Earrings, which is by far the biggest category, fell only 5.6%, and hair accessories 9.2%. **[Dataset]**

Two things stand out to me here. First, in rupee terms the earring drop matters most even though it is the smallest percentage on the chart: 5.6% of an average ₹6,91,690 a month is a bigger loss than 44.8% of bangles. Second, the categories that are rising are the dearer ones — neck sets, bracelets and chain-pendant sets all sit in the value corner of Figure 4. That is the same price effect I found in Section 3.1, and here I can finally see where it is coming from: the mix is tilting towards more expensive items. I cannot tell from this file whether that is because demand changed, because the buying changed, or because the falling categories were out of stock, and I would not want to guess. **[To be tested]**

3.6 ABC classification of the merchandise portfolio

This is the revenue-weighted ABC view that I said in the mid-term I would leave for the final report. In Figure 8 I have sorted the 38 categories by revenue and cut them at the usual 80% and 95% marks. The result surprised me: **seven categories reach 81.8%** of merchandise revenue, another nine take the running total to 95.7%, and the remaining twenty-two categories together contribute 4.3%. Table 4 names the members of each band. **[Dataset]**

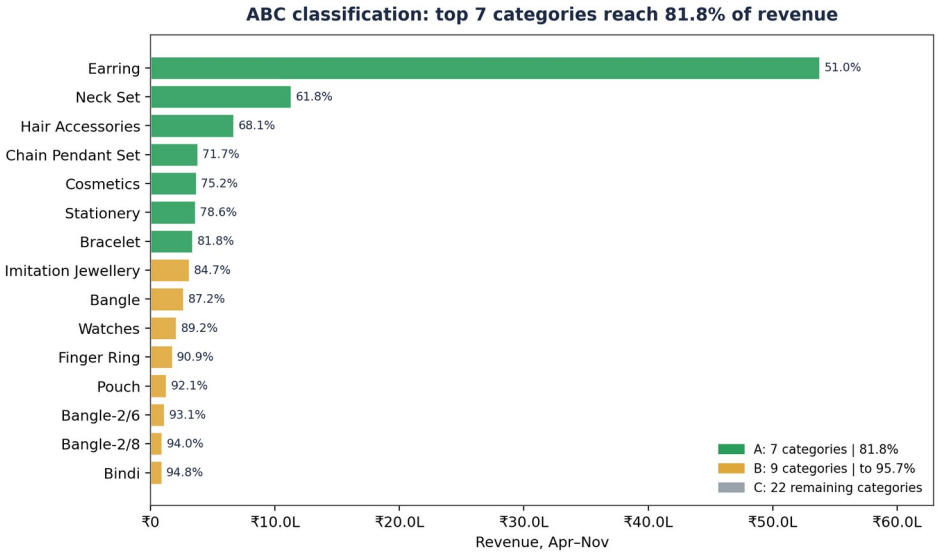


Figure 8: ABC classification of the 38 customer-merchandise categories, fifteen largest shown with cumulative share labelled

Table 4: ABC bands and what each band contains

Band	Categories	Revenue	Share of revenue	Share of U-IDs	Members
A	7	₹86.20 lakh	81.8%	82.7%	Earring, neck set, hair accessories, chain pendant set, cosmetics, stationery, bracelet
B	9	₹14.65 lakh	13.9%	11.9%	Imitation jewellery, bangle, watches, finger ring, pouch, bangle-2/6, bangle-2/8, bindi, hand purse
C	22	₹4.54 lakh	4.3%	5.4%	Comb, bangle-2/4, nail polish, hipchain, anklet and seventeen further small categories

Source: author's calculation. Bands defined in Table 3. Shares of U-IDs are computed on the 5,813 identifiers active in the window. [Dataset]

I want to be careful about the C band rather than take a red pen to it. Those twenty-two categories hold only 5.4% of the active product identifiers, so they are not taking up much of the catalogue, and several of them — nail polish, combs, anklets, hipchains — are exactly the sort of cheap add-on a customer picks up at the counter with something else. I have no bill-level data, so I cannot show whether they

actually do that, and I have no cost data, so I cannot show what they earn. Calling them poor performers would be a conclusion I cannot support, so I am not making it.

3.7 Inside earrings: the sub-type deep dive

Once I saw that one category is half the business, I decided it needed a chart of its own. Earrings produce ₹53,79,283 — **51.0%** of merchandise revenue — across 43,989 units, 3,416 distinct product identifiers and 37 recorded sub-types, at a realised price of ₹122.29. **[Dataset]**

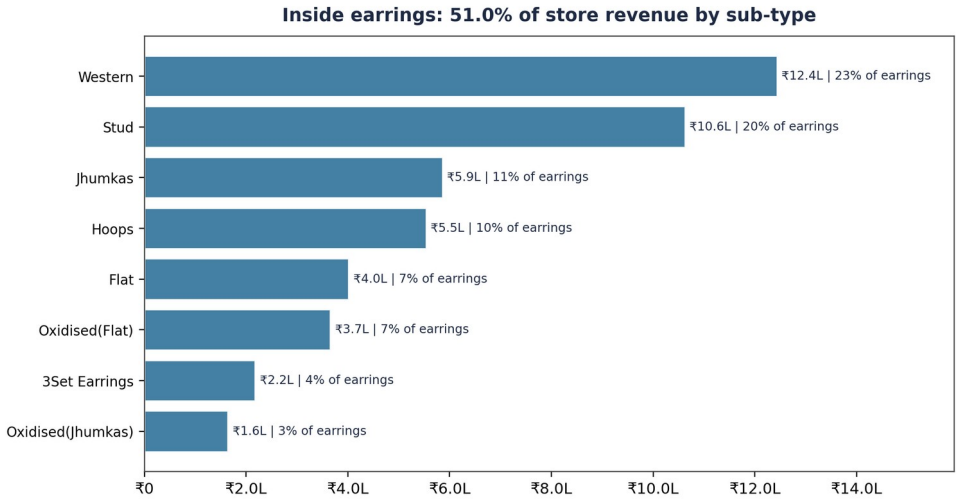


Figure 9: Earring revenue by sub-type, eight largest sub-types, with each sub-type's share of total earring revenue

Table 5: Earring sub-types ranked by revenue

Sub-type	Revenue	Units	U-IDs	Realised price	% of earrings	% of store
Western	₹12,43,841	10,468	697	₹118.8	23.1%	11.8%
Stud	₹10,62,246	9,416	633	₹112.8	19.7%	10.1%
Jhumkas	₹5,86,215	7,006	328	₹83.7	10.9%	5.6%
Hoops	₹5,53,626	4,507	380	₹122.8	10.3%	5.3%
Flat	₹4,01,593	2,404	377	₹167.1	7.5%	3.8%
Oxidised (flat)	₹3,65,606	2,010	172	₹181.9	6.8%	3.5%
3-set earrings	₹2,17,839	1,246	66	₹174.8	4.0%	2.1%
Oxidised (jhumkas)	₹1,64,284	902	101	₹182.1	3.1%	1.6%
Top five combined	₹38,47,522	33,801	2,415	—	71.5%	36.5%

Source: author's calculation. Percentages are of April–November earring revenue and of total customer-merchandise revenue respectively. Each figure is rounded independently from the unrounded value, so a column may differ by one rupee or one decimal from the sum of the rows above it. [Dataset]

The concentration inside earrings is just as sharp as the concentration across the shop. The top five sub-types — western, stud, jhumkas, hoops and flat — carry **71.5% of earring revenue** and **36.5% of the whole store**. Two of them, western and stud, are 42.9% of earrings between them. The realised prices split the group quite neatly: jhumkas are the cheapest at ₹83.7 a piece and move the most units for the revenue they bring, while flat and oxidised-flat sit near ₹167–₹182. So even inside this one category the shop is running both a volume line and a value line. **[Dataset]**

3.8 Corrected scope scores and the candidate field

This is the structured shortlist of local micro-influencers that I promised at the end of the mid-term report. Figure 10 shows my corrected scores for the fifteen candidates and Figure 11 puts the same accounts on the two dimensions the score is built from. I use the proxy names A to O throughout, as I did in the mid-term, and I do not print anyone's public handle.

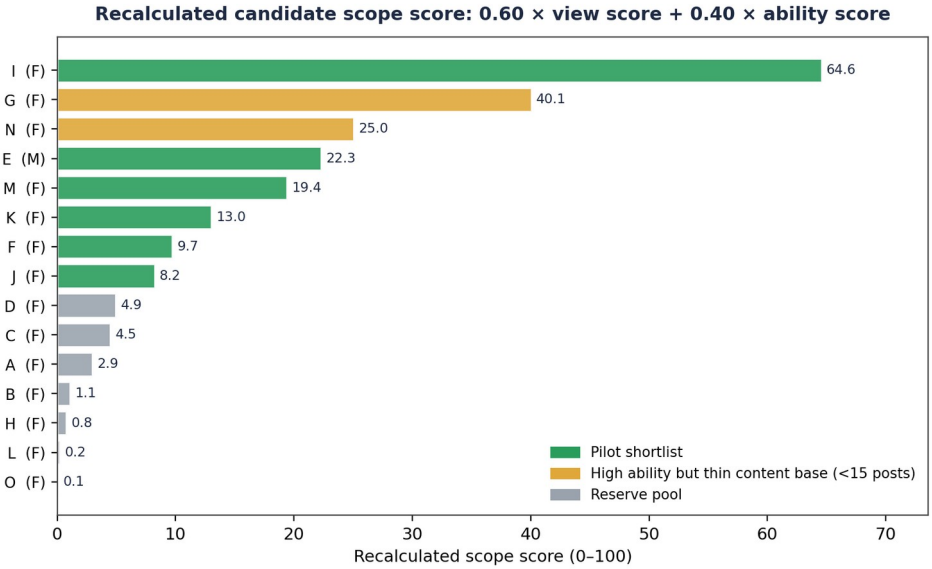


Figure 10: Recalculated scope score for the fifteen candidate accounts, on a 0–100 scale

My corrected score has a real weakness, and the chart makes it visible, so I would rather point it out myself than hide it behind the ranking. Min–max scaling is very sensitive to the extreme values at both ends. Candidate I scores 64.6 mostly because one reel reached 7.1 million views, about three times the next highest, so that single reel is what sets the top of my view scale. At the other end, candidates G and N score 40.1 and 25.0 almost entirely on the ability part of the score — not because they have big audiences, but because they have only posted five and six times, and dividing by a small number makes the ratio look large. Their peak views are 9,510 and 5,112, which are among the lowest in my sample. **[Dataset]**

So I added one more filter before drawing up my shortlist: a candidate has to have at least fifteen posts. I chose fifteen because a shop cannot brief, review or depend on an account that has almost nothing published, and because an ability ratio worked out from five posts is really just an accident of the arithmetic and not a sign of ability. This is my own cut-off and not something the data told me, so I am stating it openly here and anyone re-running my work can change it or drop it.

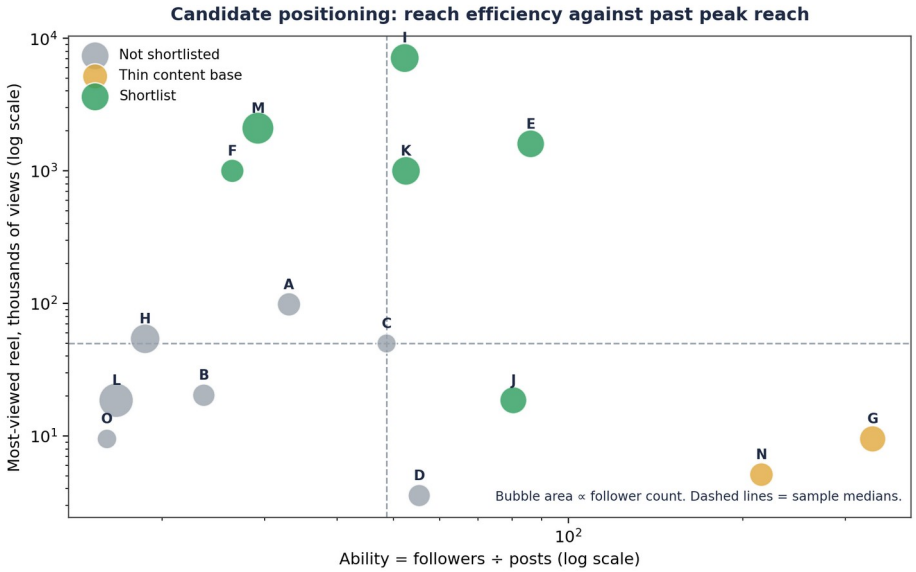


Figure 11: Candidate positioning: reach efficiency (followers per post) against past peak reel reach, both on logarithmic scales; bubble area proportional to follower count

Table 6: Recalculated scorecard for all fifteen candidates, ranked by corrected scope score

Proxy	Gender	Cohort	Followers	Posts	Peak reel views	Ability	View score	Ability score	Scope	Status
I	F	NIFT'28	2,092	40	7,100,000	52.3	1.000	0.114	64.6	Shortlist
G	F	NIFT'27	1,672	5	9,510	334.4	0.001	1.000	40.1	Held — thin base
N	F	NIFT'27	1,291	6	5,112	215.2	0.000	0.625	25.0	Held — thin base
E	M	NIFT'26	1,896	22	1,600,000	86.2	0.225	0.220	22.3	Shortlist
M	F	NIFT'29	2,630	90	2,100,000	29.2	0.295	0.041	19.4	Shortlist
K	F	NIFT'28	2,050	39	1,000,000	52.6	0.140	0.115	13.0	Shortlist
F	F	NIFT'27	1,241	47	1,000,000	26.4	0.140	0.032	9.7	Shortlist
J	F	NIFT'28	1,770	22	18,600	80.5	0.002	0.202	8.2	Shortlist
D	F	NIFT'29	1,108	20	3,554	55.4	0.000	0.124	4.9	Reserve pool
C	F	NIFT'29	730	15	49,900	48.7	0.007	0.102	4.5	Reserve pool
A	F	NIFT'29	1,256	38	98,400	33.1	0.013	0.053	2.9	Reserve pool
B	F	NIFT'29	1,132	48	20,300	23.6	0.002	0.024	1.1	Reserve pool
H	F	NIFT'27	2,205	118	54,100	18.7	0.007	0.008	0.8	Reserve pool
L	F	NIFT'28	3,098	186	18,600	16.7	0.002	0.002	0.2	Reserve pool
O	F	NIFT'28	787	49	9,504	16.1	0.001	0.000	0.1	Reserve pool

Source: author's calculation on Nift students.xlsx, snapshot mid-January 2026. Ability = followers ÷ posts. [Dataset]

Six candidates get through both my corrected score and my fifteen-post filter. Five of them are female, which fits a shop whose customers are almost all women. The sixth, candidate E, is male, and I have kept him in on purpose rather than in spite of it: he has the second-highest score of everyone who passes the filter, he has a reel at 1.6 million views, and he posts design-college content that would put the store in front of a female student audience by a route the other five do not give me. Whether that novelty actually converts is exactly the kind of thing I want the pilot to find out. **[To be tested]**

Table 7: Pilot shortlist and the reason each candidate is on it

Proxy	Scope	Followers	Posts	Peak views	Why this candidate is on the list
I	64.6	2,092	40	7,100,000	Highest corrected score by a wide margin and the only candidate with a reel past seven million views. Forty posts is a workable body of content to brief against. Lead creator for the pilot.
E	22.3	1,896	22	1,600,000	Second on the corrected score among candidates passing the post screen, and the highest ability ratio in that group. The strategic male wildcard.
M	19.4	2,630	90	2,100,000	Strong past peak reach with the largest published body of work in the shortlist, which lowers the risk that a campaign post is out of character for the account.
K	13.0	2,050	39	1,000,000	A million-view reel with a balanced profile — roughly two thousand followers on thirty-nine posts — and the most recent posting activity in the group.
F	9.7	1,241	47	1,000,000	Matches K on peak reach with a comparable posting cadence, giving the pilot a second creator at a similar level rather than one dominant account and a long tail.
J	8.2	1,770	22	18,600	The sixth slot on ability rather than peak reach: a high followers-per-post ratio on a genuine twenty-two-post base, testing whether efficiency without a viral history still delivers.

Candidates G and N are held rather than rejected: both show high ability ratios and should be reconsidered once they have a larger body of published work. The remaining seven form a reserve pool for a second wave. [Dataset]

4 Interpretation of Results and Recommendations

4.1 Product and store performance

Interpretation of results

When I read my charts together instead of one at a time, three things come out. First, **the shop is really one product with a supporting cast.** Earrings are 51.0% of revenue and 58.8% of the active product identifiers; five earring sub-types on their own are 36.5% of the shop, and adding neck sets and hair accessories takes three categories to 68.1%. I do not think this is automatically a bad thing — being known for one thing is an asset for a small shop on a busy street — but it does mean that the shop's revenue and the earring shelf are almost the same thing. If western or stud earrings ran out for four weeks, I would expect to see it in the monthly totals straight away.

Second, **price is doing the work that volume used to do.** Units fell 6.6% between the two halves while revenue fell only 3.2%, and the realised price went up from ₹122.3 to ₹139.1. Figure 7 shows me where that came from: the categories that grew are the dearer ones. I think this is a comfortable place to be for a quarter and an uncomfortable one to rely on, because a rising average bill in a shop with falling footfall usually means fewer customers spending a bit more, not more customers. I cannot confirm that from this file, because there are no customer records in it, but it is the reading that fits the evidence best, and it points the marketing problem at footfall rather than at basket size. **[To be tested]**

Third, **the middle price range is where the assortment decisions matter.** Just under two-thirds of revenue comes from the ₹100–₹500 range and 88.3% from everything at or below ₹500. Moving the shop upmarket would not be a small adjustment; it would mean working against the price expectation that brings people in through the door in the first place. What I think is realistic inside this range is going deeper on what already sells and being disciplined about what does not need to be broad.

Actionable recommendations

- **Put the five leading earring sub-types on a weekly stock check.** Western, stud, jhumkas, hoops and flat carry 36.5% of the shop between them, so I would put a written reorder trigger on these five ahead of every other line. I think this is the single most useful control the owner has. **Success test:** none of these five is out of display stock for more than three days in a month. **Evidence:** Figure 9, Table 5.
- **Give neck sets, bracelets and chain-pendant sets a better display position** even though they sell few pieces, because each sale is worth five to ten ordinary sales and all three of them grew between the two halves. **Success test:** the combined monthly revenue of the three rises above its April–November average within ninety days. **Evidence:** Figure 4, Figure 7.
- **Check the four biggest fallers before changing what is bought.** I would look at bangles, watches, pouches and finger rings against the supplier and delivery records first, because in my data a gap in supply and a drop in demand look exactly the same. **Success test:** a written one-line reason for each of the four, taken from purchase records rather than guessed. **Evidence:** Figure 7.
- **Start writing down stock-outs from today, on paper if that is easier** — just the date and the item, every time a customer asks for something that is not there. **Success test:** a stock-out log with at least thirty entries after one month.

Implementation and impact

None of these four actions costs anything except attention, and all of them can start this week. I am not expecting them to produce a jump in revenue; what I expect is that they stop an avoidable loss. If the earring shelf really is the shop, then keeping five sub-types on the shelf is worth more than any promotion applied to the other thirty-three categories. The display change works on the second engine I found in Figure 4, where the problem is being seen rather than selling enough. Both effects will show up in the same monthly file the owner already exports, which means she can judge my recommendations instead of having to believe them.

4.2 Local brand awareness and marketing efficiency

Interpretation of results

The second problem is the ₹40,000 a month, which is the same problem I set out in the mid-term. What frustrates the owner is not that the amount is large but that nothing comes back that she can count. **[Owner-reported]** The concentration I found in Section 3 cuts both ways here. Seven categories carry 81.8% of revenue and twenty-two carry 4.3%, and for spending a marketing rupee that is actually helpful: any awareness campaign has an obvious hero product to lead with, the shop does not have to explain forty categories to a new customer, and the campaign can be measured against one narrow shelf. The same concentration that creates the stock risk makes a creator campaign easy to brief, easy to stock for and easy to attribute.

In the mid-term I listed five reasons for going to student creators instead of the present arrangement. I still think they are the right reasons, but I want to restate them here as arguments I intend to test, not as things I have shown. **Cost efficiency:** the present ₹40,000 monthly line could in principle fund a large number of student creators at a benchmark of around ₹1,000 each, spreading the same spend across many voices instead of one channel. **Trend authority:** fashion-design students carry credibility on what is current in a way a generic advertisement does not. **Peer diffusion:** engaging a visible few can pull others on the same campus towards the brand without further spend. **Hyper-local engagement:** a campus roughly within the store's catchment should convert views into walk-ins more readily than untargeted reach. **Authentic content:** brand placement inside a student's own styling and project work reads as genuine rather than paid. **[Owner-reported] [To be tested]**

I want to add two cautions to that. The ₹1,000 figure I used in the mid-term is only a planning benchmark I picked to size the idea; nobody has quoted it and nobody has agreed to it. The real payment has to be negotiated with each student and it may well be higher, or it may be product instead of cash. Also, my own SWOT already flags the reputation risk that comes with paid influencers, so I would agree content standards and a written disclosure rule before anything at all is posted.

Actionable recommendations

- **Run a thirty-day pilot with the six students I shortlisted in Table 7,** built around the earring shelf, because that is the clearest hero the shop has and the easiest one to stock deeply. What I would negotiate with each student is roughly two reels, a set of stories with the store location tagged, one visit to the shop, a styling demonstration using pieces they pick themselves, and the use of what they buy in their normal campus and project posts. At my benchmark rate that is about ₹6,000 in fees plus the cost of product, against the ₹40,000 the owner is spending every month right now.
- **Give every student a unique discount code and a printed QR code,** and ask the staff to write one line at the counter whenever a code, a QR or a student's name is mentioned. No customer details need to be written down at all. Table 8 sets out the full measurement plan. If this step is skipped then the pilot cannot be measured and I have simply repeated the problem I was trying to solve.
- **Ask each shortlisted student for their audience-city breakdown before paying anything,** and put the payment, the content standards and the paid-partnership disclosure in writing. **Success test:** six signed one-page agreements, each with a city-mix screenshot attached.
- **Keep the existing ₹40,000 spend running during the pilot month, do not cut it,** so that I am comparing the two channels under the same trading conditions. **Success test:** at day 30 I have a cost per attributed visit for both channels, or I have written down that the existing channel cannot be measured at all.

Table 8: Thirty-day pilot measurement framework

What is measured	How it is captured	Why it matters
Content views and reach	Creator-supplied insights screenshot per deliverable, at day 15 and day 30	Establishes actual delivered reach against the peak-view ceiling used for scoring
Audience city mix	Creator-supplied audience-geography screenshot, before the first post	Tests the local-audience assumption that the entire approach depends on
Store visits mentioning a creator	Staff campaign log at the counter — one line	The first direct evidence that digital reach becomes

What is measured	How it is captured	Why it matters
	per mention	physical footfall
Code and QR redemptions	Billing system, one unique code per creator	Attributes a purchase to a specific creator rather than to the campaign as a whole
Attributed sales value	Sum of net bill value on redeemed codes	The numerator for any cost comparison against the current spend
Cost per attributed visit and per attributed sale	Negotiated fee plus product cost ÷ logged visits, and ÷ redemptions	The single number that decides whether this scales, continues or stops
Category mix of attributed sales	Item lines on redeemed bills, grouped using the same 38-category correction	Shows whether the campaign pulls the hero shelf or spreads across the range

No return on investment is claimed anywhere in this report, and none should be quoted until this framework has produced thirty days of data. [To be tested]

Implementation and impact

I have kept the pilot deliberately small. Six students at my benchmark of ₹6,000 is about fifteen percent of one month's existing marketing spend, so it can be run without disturbing the current channel and without asking the owner to bet on an idea nobody has tested. What I really want out of it is not reach but a number the business has never had: the cost per store visit and the cost per sale that I can actually attribute. Once that number exists it can be put straight next to the ₹40,000 line, and the decision to grow the student programme, renegotiate the existing spend or stop the experiment becomes a matter of arithmetic instead of opinion. If the pilot works, the reserve pool in Table 6 gives me a second group without starting the search again. If it does not work, the shop has spent about ₹6,000 to find out something it was otherwise going to keep paying not to know.

4.3 Limitations and the next data to capture

There are three limits that affect everything I have written above, and I would rather say them plainly than let a reader find them. Eight full months let me describe what happened but not draw conclusions about why, so nothing I have said about a monthly pattern should be read as a seasonal finding. I have no cost, stock or stock-out data, so I have not assessed any category for profitability and I could not have done, and the low-volume categories in the C band are described as low-volume and nothing more. My student sample is fifteen accounts I collected by hand from one campus network, and I could not verify where their followers are, so my shortlist is a sensible place to start a pilot and not evidence that the pilot will work. Two smaller limits are also mine to own: the min–max scaling behind my scope score is sensitive to extreme values, as I showed in Section 3.8, and my fifteen-post filter is a judgement I made rather than a threshold the data gave me; and my category correction contains one judgement of my own — that boxes, pouches and paper bags are packaging and not merchandise — which involves 338 units and ₹9,732, small enough that reversing it would not change any of my conclusions.

I think the next round of analysis will gain far more from closing these gaps than from applying any new technique to the file I already have. These are the three things I would ask for, in the order I would ask for them:

- **Ask the franchisor for cost price at category level, and write down opening and closing stock every month.** This would let me work out margin by category, and with it every profitability question I had to refuse in this report.
- **Capture bill-level data with a bill number,** even without customer names, so that I can see what goes into a basket together and how often C-band items get added to an A-band purchase.
- **Keep exporting the same monthly item-wise file,** so that next year I can compare April–November 2026 against April–November 2025 and finally test the monthly patterns in Figure 5 instead of only describing them.

4.4 Conclusion

In the mid-term I could only say that revenue was gently falling. Having now finished the work I promised there, I can say something much more useful. DIFA Velachery turned over ₹1,05,39,048 of

customer merchandise across the eight full months I was able to analyse, and that revenue is far more concentrated than the owner had realised: seven of thirty-eight categories carry 81.8% of it, earrings alone carry 51.0%, and five earring sub-types carry 36.5% of the entire shop. Volume is falling faster than revenue, which tells me that a rising average bill is currently hiding a footfall problem rather than fixing it.

That points both halves of my project at the same target. On the shelf, the thing to work on is stock discipline on a small number of hero lines and a better position for the few high-value categories that are growing. On the marketing side, my answer to ₹40,000 a month that cannot be measured is not necessarily less money but money that can be traced: six shortlisted students, unique codes at the till, and a thirty-day window after which the owner will know her cost per attributed visit for the first time. Neither of my recommendations asks her to believe anything I have not shown her, and both are built so that she can judge them on evidence she will be holding thirty days from now.

References and Source Notes

Source	What it provided	Nature
Business sales data.xlsx, sheet “Clean data”	Every sales figure in Sections 2, 3 and 4. Item-month records for April–December 2025, shared by the store owner on 7 December 2025 under franchise confidentiality restrictions.	Primary
DIFA_sales_analysis.ipynb	The Python notebook that produces Figures 3 to 9 and every value quoted from them, including the category-correction rules in Table 2.	Author’s analysis
Nift students.xlsx	The fifteen candidate accounts and their follower, post, peak-view, cohort, gender and last-post fields, collected manually from public Instagram profiles in January 2026.	Primary
Business model canvas and SWOT	Figures 1 and 2, prepared with the store owner during the mid-term stage.	Owner-reported
Mid-term report (23f2002469)	Data cleaning provenance, U-ID construction, discount-merge validation and the descriptive baseline summarised in Section 2.2.	Author’s prior work
Conversations with the store owner	Marketing spend, channel structure, staffing, competitive setting and the explanations marked [Owner-reported] throughout.	Primary, unverified

No third-party market research, published report or external dataset was used. All figures were produced by the author from the two primary sources named above. Figures 3 to 9 are reproduced by running the accompanying notebook against the “Clean data” sheet; Figures 10 and 11 and Table 6 are reproduced from the candidate sheet using the formulas in Table 3.